

TERMINOLOGY CHEAT SHEET

Industry Terms Translated for Real People

Industry Term	What It Means for You	Why It Matters
PCR (Property Condition Report)	The primary data-driven document you submit	This is what you get paid for—photos + objective notes
SLA (Service Level Agreement)	The Deadline	Contractual timeframe (typically 3-7 days). Miss it = no payment
REO (Real Estate Owned)	Bank-Owned Property	Finished foreclosure. Usually requires weekly "checks" for maintenance
Loss Draft	Repair Verification	Verify if insurance money is being used to fix property damage
FTV (First-Time Vacant)	First report confirming home is empty	Critical milestone—confirms no one is living there anymore
Waste	Neglect/Damage	Legal term for property deterioration that reduces lender value
Drive-By	Exterior Only inspection	Visual check from public right-of-way (often for bankruptcy cases)
Occupancy Determination	Occupied, Vacant, or Unable to Determine	Your job: document evidence of residency (or lack thereof)
Interior Authorized	You're allowed to go inside (if safe)	Check work order for this status before entering property
Exterior Only	Stay on public areas	Street and sidewalk photos only—do not enter property
6-Angle Rule	Minimum required photos	Street sign, house number, front, front-left, front-right, street views
Coordinator	Your point of contact	Assigns work, reviews submissions, answers questions—your ally

PRO TIPS FOR BEGINNERS

Use the right language: When talking to coordinators, use industry terms (PCR, SLA, FTV). Shows you're professional.

Never guess: If you're unsure about occupancy, document what you observe and mark "Unable to Determine" rather than guessing.

SLAs are sacred: Missing deadlines = no payment + damaged reputation. Plan your routes to hit deadlines with buffer time.

Coordinators are your allies: When in doubt, ask. They'd rather answer questions than receive a rejected report.